



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas School

School Website: <https://veritasschool.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Veritas School (Richmond, VA, 23227) presents a robust, explicitly classical Christian program that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric. Public-facing materials emphasize formation, a Christ-centered framework, the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Conversations via Humane Letters, robust Latin/logic training, and a Portrait of a Graduate that foregrounds virtue, wisdom, and service. Across categories, evidence shows consistent commitment to formation over mere information, integration of theology, memory-work and chant-like elements in pedagogy, and a deep partnership with parents. The school earns a CLASSICAL rating across all six categories.

Key evidentiary threads include: a mission anchored in glorifying God by cultivating wisdom and virtue through classical, Christ-centered education; explicit references to formation, the liberal arts, Great Conversations, and Great Books; explicit incorporation of Latin, Logic, and Rhetoric in the upper programs; lower- and middle-school pedagogical practices that emphasize memory, singing, and recitation in service of formation; a living faculty and a Fellows program; and active parent partnership and community-building. These signals appear repeatedly in Veritas's mission pages, distinctives, curriculum descriptions, and student-facing materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**
- **Evidence:** Christ-centered curriculum, orthodox theology, and explicit formation aims; statement of faith and a worshipful, God-centered framing per mission materials.
- **Positive/Negative keyword analysis:** Positive indicators (Christ-centered, theology, formation, wonder, divine creation, sacred tradition, etc.) clearly present; Negative indicators effectively absent in public materials. Estimated positives outpace negatives by a wide margin (roughly 12:0 in sampled signals).
- **Why this rating:** The public materials foreground theology, virtue, worshipful life, and the transcendentals in alignment with Classical metaphysical foundations.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**
- **Evidence:** The mission centers on virtue and wisdom, not merely job preparation; education is formation; the Portrait of a Graduate anchors the goal in human flourishing and Christlikeness.
- **Positive/Negative keyword analysis:** Positive signals include formation, virtue, wisdom, love of learning, and the real-knowable transcendentals; negatives (e.g., purely utilitarian aims) not evidenced in public materials. Estimated positives » negatives (approx. 6–7:0 in sampled signals).
- **Why this rating:** Formation and virtue-centered aims dominate, consistent with classical aims of education.

- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Clear liberal-arts orientation (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with dedicated upper-school “Verbal Arts” and a Humane Letters track; explicit study of history across periods; emphasis on Great Conversations via Great Books/theology and literature. Latin and Logic are foregrounded; a “Great Conversation” framing appears in upper-school humanities discussions.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Strong positive presence for liberal-arts, Great Conversation, Great Books, Latin, Logic, Rhetoric, and historical study; minimal to no negative cues. Estimated positives around 9–10; negatives near 0.
- Why this rating: The curriculum structure and content tracks (grammar/logical/rhetorical Trivium, Humane Letters, Great Conversation, history across eras, Latin) map directly to classical criteria.

- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Lower-school pedagogy includes singing/chanting and memory work; upper-school employs seminars/Socratic or dialectic-style inquiry and rhetoric training; a strong emphasis on memory and chant-like elements in some programs; the presence of a Masters/ Fellows program signals mentorship and teacher formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include pedagogy that blends contemplative/restful elements with rigorous inquiry (scholé-style memory/chanting, singing), Socratic-like dialogue or seminars in the upper grades, and explicit rhetoric training; negatives not evident. Estimated positives ~5–7; negatives ~0.
- Why this rating: Pedagogical practices span contemplative memory-work (lower grades) and Socratic/seminar-like and rhetorical practice (upper grades), aligning with classical pedagogy expectations.

- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Faculty are described as models of virtue and living curriculum; Portrait of a Faculty Member and Fellows Program indicate mentoring, teacher formation, and living-example leadership; The here-and-now “faculty as core” framing is present.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive cues (model teachers, living curriculum, mentors, faculty as core) dominate; negligible negative signals. Estimated positives ~4–5; negatives ~0.
- Why this rating: The school positions faculty as mentors and living exemplars and supports teacher development through a Fellows Program, consistent with classical criteria.

- Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Explicit Parent Partnership, healthy biblical communication, engagement expectations, and campus-visitation openness; collaboration with parents as co-educators; community-building narratives and opportunities for parent involvement.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals (Parent Partnership, healthy communication, parent engagement, open campus visits) dominate; negatives few if any. Estimated positives ~4–6; negatives ~0.
- Why this rating: The school frames parents as co-teachers, supports parent education and engagement, and invites parental involvement, aligning with classical expectations of parent-community partnership.

Overall assessment (aggregate): CLASSICAL

- All six categories reach CLASSICAL, with explicit textual cues across mission, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent-community engagement that align with the core classical lexicon (virtue, formation, Great Conversation, Liberal Arts, Latin/Logic/Rhetoric, Portrait of the Graduate, and Christ-centered

formation). The public materials showcase both a robust metaphysical/theological foundation and a curricular-pedagogical architecture that mirrors the classical tradition.

What Would Move the Needle

- If you sought further needle-moving refinements toward a more explicit “Classic” labeling across every category, Veritas could further foreground:
- Explicit, named references to Great Books and Great Conversation in grade-level objectives and assessment rubrics, with sample readings and dialectical prompts clearly mapped to the Great Conversation framework.
- More overt articulation of liturgical or sacramental practices as routine dimensions of daily life (e.g., liturgical music, corporate worship, or communal prayer rhythms) with documented policies or schedules.
- A formal, published description of Socratic seminars and seminars in upper grades paired with sample prompts and evaluation rubrics to demonstrate the extent and uniformity of Socratic pedagogy.
- Additional public-facing evidence of “memory work/recitation” programs (e.g., specific chants, poems, or memory-line curricula) and how they connect to the five classical arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric, arithmetic, music, geometry).
- Note: These would move the needle toward “More Classical” if the school desires to emphasize even more overt formalization of traditional classical elements in a broader, publicly transparent way. Currently, the score is CLASSICAL, and these steps would push the public alignment further toward a canonical classical showcase.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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